

LING 102 section week 3 (2/16)

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1 Auxiliaries in English

Here are the rules we have so far for auxiliaries in English:

- (1)
 - a. $S \rightarrow NP \text{ (Aux) VP}$
 - b. $Aux \rightarrow (\{\text{infinitive, modal}\}) \text{ (perfective) (progressive)}$
 - c. auxiliaries: *to* (infinitive); *can, could, will, would, shall, should, may, must* (modal)
have (perfective), *be* (progressive)
- (2)
 - a. try constructing two sentences that combines multiple of the auxiliaries above:
 - b. modals can express a range of possibility and necessity—we call this the *modal force*.
can you identify which auxiliaries do what? (e.g. ‘can’ expresses possibility)
 - c. modals are evaluated with respect to different contexts—we call these *modal bases*.
 - 1) *epistemic modals* expresses truth in terms of facts that are known and/or believed
 - 2) *deontic modals* indicates a state of norms, expectations, and/or desires in the wordsome auxiliaries can be used in both these ways—can you come up with examples?
 - d. is there a pattern with *can* vs. *could*, *will* vs. *would*, and *shall* vs. *should*?
 - e. what about the auxiliaries *do* and *did*? what functions do you think they have?

2 Lexical vs. functional heads

It is sometimes helpful to think of different heads (and their phrases) in the following manner:

- (3)
 - a. **lexical**: words that are contentful and have concrete meaning, e.g. N, V, Adj, Adv
 - b. **functional**: words that have a grammatical function, e.g. Aux, Det, C, P, etc.

We will learn in class that these two types of heads are distributed in a fairly systematic way.

3 Practice with trees

Let's practice drawing some trees:

- (4) a. Charlie's grandmother told us a very scary story.
b. I will be reminding the students to turn in their homework.
- (5) wada mita kingal boyak lmiqu laqi ga
PST see a boar big child that
'That child saw a big boar.' (Seediq; Austronesian)